

▲ MEDAL OF HONOR

Date 1861

Origin US

The Medal of Honor is the highest medal for "valor in combat" that can be awarded to members of the US Armed Forces. First authorized in 1861 for issue to sailors and marines, the medal was extended to soldiers in 1862. Since then, more than 3,400 Medals of Honor have been awarded to personnel from all the armed services.



Laurel wreath symbolizes victory

A total of six silver clasps were authorized

▲ SOUTH AFRICA MEDAL

Date 1879

Origin UK

Conflict South Africa campaigns

This was issued by the British Government to members of the British Army and Naval Brigade who served in the South African tribal wars between 1877 and 1879. Most awards were made for actions during the Anglo-Zulu War (1879), especially the battles of Isandlwana and Rorke's Drift.

► ORDER OF THE RISING SUN

Date 1875

Origin Japan

Established in 1875 by Emperor Meiji of Japan, the Order of the Rising Sun was the country's first national decoration. The version shown here is a 7th class medal, showing Paulownia flowers and leaves.



► LÉGION D'HONNEUR

Date 1802

Origin France

Instituted by Napoleon Bonaparte in 1802 as an award for outstanding civil or military service to France, the Ordre Royal, Imperial, et National de la Légion d'Honneur is still one of France's highest awards. The pictured design was awarded between 1870 and 1951.

▲ AFGHANISTAN MEDAL

Date 1881

Origin UK

Conflict Anglo-Afghan Wars

This medal was awarded to British and Indian forces, who took part in the Second Anglo-Afghan War, which consisted of a series of battles between 1878 and 1880. The war ended with a British victory at Kandahar in 1880.



Imperial crown joins cross and ribbon

◀ QUEEN'S SOUTH AFRICA MEDAL

Date 1899

Origin UK

Conflict Anglo-Boer Wars

Awarded to personnel who served in the Second Anglo-Boer War in South Africa (1899–1902), with 178,000 medals issued, and 26 authorized clasps, this is one of the most widespread of all military medals.

